



Amazon Prime Gaming India

Amazon Prime is gearing up to introduce its Amazon Prime Gaming services in India. <https://digit.in/dec22-17>



Apple VR/AR headset

Apple's recently revealed VR/AR headsets are facing a few shipment delays. <https://digit.in/dec22-18>

by these mishaps. On the sidelines of a video-conferencing event at the International Conference on Machine Vision and Augmented Intelligence (MAI) 2022, the politico had expressed his worry over the shocking figure of five lakh road accidents being reported on a yearly basis.

PUSH FOR AI ADOPTION

Laying an emphasis on the significant issue of road safety and its awareness, Gadkari admits that security during travel poses a significant challenge to most developing countries like India. Sad but true, 70% casualties are said to be in the young age bracket of 18-45 years. He categorically recommends the adoption of AI-enabled technology to debar human involvement and detect flaws in transportation.

Anmol Bohre, co-founder and managing director of Enigma Automobiles Private Limited, sounds optimistic about the feasibility of driverless technology in India. "Yes I do believe that the day won't be far when we will be able to witness autonomous driving in real practice instead of imagining it as just a myth," shares Bohre, spearheading a startup in the EV market.

"With our vehicles being well-equipped with ADAS (Advanced Driver Assistance Systems) and an enterprising transport minister like Mr. Gadkari at the helm, this breakthrough is highly probable. In a recent parliamentary session, he pledged that India's road infrastructure will match the United States' standards by 2024," he enthuses.

Industry bigwigs that jumped on the bandwagon of automotive AI internationally, include Audi, BMW, Ford, Google, General Motors, Tesla, Volkswagen, Volvo, among others. While A-listers like Hyundai's EV ambition seems well on track with a couple of heavyweight introductions pending in India, the autonomous dream of Ford and Volkswagen is yet to spread its wings in the domestic car market.

AI... WHAT KIND?

Veering the conversation to convert-

ible vehicle models, Bohre agrees that ordinary vehicles can be repurposed as electric ones. "It is definitely doable. But transforming an ICE (traditional Internal Combustion Engines) vehicle platform into an EV is the biggest mistake an OEM (original equipment manufacturer) can make. Future and current vehicles purely built on an EV platform will be the ideal samples for adaptability rather than hybrid or fuel-filled versions," he opines.

Engineering wise, the design and parts of an autonomous car are expectedly different from a normal variety plying on the road. Therefore, "installation of key digital components or the integration of AI requires embedded vision (computer vision in machines using algorithms to decode meaning by observing pixel patterns in images or a video grab) to provide real-time analysis. Responsiveness of AI is faster than an average human," informs Bohre.



ECONOMIC VIABILITY

Per Fortune Business Insights, the India electric vehicle market size for four wheelers was valued at USD 681.51 million in 2021. The same is predicted to reach USD 47,292.45 million by 2029 from USD 1,415.65 million in 2022, witnessing a CAGR of 65.1% during the forecast period. The Allied Market Research issues an upbeat outlook for the global automotive artificial intelligence market, which is assumed to inflate to \$8,887.6 million within 2025 from \$445.8 million in 2017, seeing a CAGR of 45.0% during the 2018-2025 time frame.

The scope of the international electric vehicle market is envisioned to

touch 39,208 thousand units by 2030 from an anticipated 8,151 thousand units in 2022, observing a CAGR of 21.7%, according to EMOBILITY+. Buoyant demand for zero carbon footprint and governments advocating vehicles with low toxic emission via incentives propelled automakers to embrace EVs and expand the EV market by a decent margin.

SMALL BUDGET UNDER START-UP SET-UP

While fingers are pointing at the cost-intensiveness of driverless technology, one may ask if startup automakers in India can manufacture AI-driven cars in modest budgets. A common Indian nuclear family may not require an enormous carriage to commute on a daily basis. In that context, can a mini variety be produced to match the purchasing capacity of mid-income groups? "We are already on track to lend fruition to our dream. An autonomous electric three-wheeler is actually being conceptualized and designed but mammoth output is necessary for its commercial viability and tightening the budget to a shoestring," imparts a techie.

Given the fact that in India, an ordinary man's modes of transport are usually buses, trams, trains, cabs, scooters, etc., can the same vehicles be rehashed into autonomous EVs to save fuel and diesel, prices of which are skyrocketing? "Yeah certainly, and many businesses are working on it already but from an engineering perspective, it's best not recommended at the moment before an extensive trial on all kinds of transport is conducted with success," Bohre sets the record straight.

"An EV has a different platform and design than an ICE (Internal Combustion Engines with traditional make, powered by gasoline, diesel biofuels or even natural gas. These represent the bulk of vehicles running daily). Thus, it won't be a prudent idea to unveil the electric counterparts immediately for public utility," he elucidates.